



Process Automation Designer

Process Automation Designer (PAD) enables process owners to author cross-enterprise workflows and create a single, unified process. You can also use Process Automation Designer to provide end-users with a simplified, task-oriented view of your process.

Roles involved in process automation

- **Developer:** Uses Flow Designer to work on flows, actions, and activity definitions to automate individual pieces of a business process
- **Process owner:** Uses Process Automation Designer to organize the pieces of the business process into a digitized, cross-enterprise workflow.
- **Workspace administrator:** Uses Playbook Experience to work on Playbooks to configure the appropriate views of the business process for the right system users
- **Agent:** Uses Agent Workspace to work on the individual tasks within the business process

Process Automation Design components

A **process** is a Now Platform representation of a cross-enterprise business process for the organization. A **trigger** specifies when to start running the process. In the process design space, a stage of a process is represented as a **lane**. Each lane can contain one or multiple **activities**, which are the building blocks that make up a process and can (just like lanes) run in sequence or in parallel. An activity defines the Flow Designer content that powers the process's automation and can also specify the user-facing experience that the process produces when it runs.

Playbook Experience allows you to configure the process representation in Agent Workspace and custom workspaces.

Six major steps involved in the process definition runtime

1. Evaluates any conditions specified in the trigger definition and **processes the trigger**
2. **Process the events in the queue** and starts running the process definition in the background



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3. **Builds the automation plans** from each activity into an entire process plan
 4. **Runs the process plan** for your process definition
 5. **Stores the process execution** information in the Process Execution [sys_pd_context] table
 6. **Supplies data for a user-facing view** of your process execution
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Benefits of using Process Automation Designer

- Connect multiple flows and actions into an end-to-end business workflow
 - Reuse existing Flow Designer flows, subflows, or actions to automate process activities
 - Organize process activities in a digitized task board interface
 - Guide end-users to complete a process in a task-oriented interface, such as a Playbook
 - Consolidate separate business processes across the organization
 - Define a consistent record lifecycle from creation to completion
 - Pass data between the activities and stages of a business process
 - Specify the conditions and the order in which activities and stages run
 - Visualize and manage the activities and stages of the process
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Limitations within Process Automation Designer

- HR tables are not supported in PAD
- Cannot define conditions on lanes
- Out of the box activities are limited
- Need to create your own activities, if needed
- Activities are dependent on subflow or action
- Process is asynchronous